Meeting notes - Migui

Meeting with the Graduate School stakeholder, 4 November 2026 - Graduate Student Lifecycle Monitoring and Analytics Platform - CAP-2521-IT. One reference for the meeting: the plan first, then the answers to likely questions, topic by topic.

Section	Use it when
1. Today's plan	Before and at the start of the meeting
2. Operations Manual approval	They ask about the manual, the 50 questions, or signing
3. UAT and the Feature Checklist	They ask how to test, who answers what, how long, how it is scored
4. The demo videos (my parts)	They ask about something they saw in one of my videos
5. General questions	Security, AIMS, technology, phone, Policy Assistant, Google Calendar
6. If something goes wrong	The site, a demo student, a screen does not behave
7. Where every file is	Someone asks for a document

1. Today's plan

The three things I ask for

#	What	What I say	File
1	Demo	"We have sent the team's demo videos. Watch them any time; each is a few minutes."	video links (whole team)
2	UAT	"Here is the feature checklist and the UAT form. Please test on miguisanson.dev and send them back by ____."	FEATURE-CHECKLIST.pdf, UAT form
3	Operations Manual	"The panel asked for your approval. We answered the 50 open questions ourselves, so you only read 4 pages and sign."	OPERATIONS-MANUAL-SUMMARY-AND-SIGN-OFF.pdf

Meeting flow (about 30 minutes)

Time	Do	Show
2 min	Say the three things I need today.	-
3 min	Demo: the team's videos are sent; give the links.	-
10 min	UAT: go through the Feature Checklist, show the UAT form, agree who tests and the deadline.	FEATURE-CHECKLIST.pdf, UAT form
10 min	Manual: page 1 (what it covers), pages 2-3 (our answers, just scroll), page 4 (sign).	OPERATIONS-MANUAL-SUMMARY-AND-SIGN-OFF.pdf
5 min	Read back what was agreed: deadlines, who tests, who signs.	-

Before the meeting

- **Dates:** UAT back by ____ (about 1 week). Manual corrections within 7 days of signing.
- **Reset the demo data:** close the 'USLS site' window, double-click deploy\RESET-DEMO-DATA.cmd, then deploy\START-SITE.cmd.
- **Check the site:** open https://miguisanson.dev/api/health on the phone; it should say "status":"ok".
- **Files:** the 4 PDFs in 'For Stakeholder' (with the full Operations Manual) ready to share on screen and to send.
- **Videos:** mine (2d, 2h, 2l) uploaded with a link; groupmates' videos collected so all go out together.

The one-sentence story (if asked what the project is)

- **Problem:** the Graduate School tracks each student's journey in separate Excel sheets, e-mails and paper letters, so nobody can see at once where a student is, what is waiting, or who must act next.
- **Our answer:** one portal that follows every student from admission to graduation, applies the Handbook rules on each screen, routes each request to the right office and the Dean, keeps an audit trail of who did what, and turns the records into reports.
- **What it is not:** not the system of record. AIMS stays the official source for student identity, enrollment and grades; the portal monitors, coordinates and supports decisions on top of it.

2. Operations Manual approval

What they get: OPERATIONS-MANUAL-SUMMARY-AND-SIGN-OFF.pdf, 4 pages, a companion to the manual as submitted (draft v0.2, 113 pages). The manual itself is not changed. Page 1 = what the manual covers; pages 2-3 = our answer to each of the 50 open questions (OQ-01 to OQ-50), each with its basis; page 4 = sign-off and a corrections table.

What signing means: the manual is approved as the working manual for UAT, with our answers. Corrections may come within 7 days; an answer with no correction stands. Items marked Office stay open until the office sends them. We enter corrections in the next version and its change log (manual Chapter 7.2).

Q: Why did you answer the questions yourselves?

A: To save the office's time. We followed the Graduate Programs Student Handbook 2022-2023 wherever it is clear, the Research Protocol AY 2024-2025 where it is newer, and otherwise what the platform already does. Each answer names its basis. The office only corrects what is wrong.

Q: What if we disagree with an answer?

A: Write it in the corrections table on page 4 or e-mail it within 7 days. We change the manual and the platform, and record it in the change log.

Q: Is the manual official after signing?

A: It becomes the approved working manual for testing. The Graduate School decides when it becomes an official USLS document.

Q: What does 'Office' mean in the Basis column?

A: A detail only the office can give: fee amounts (Business Office), practicum hours, graduation dates and checklist, Registrar and AIMS file formats, office mailboxes, records retention. Until it arrives, the platform shows it as 'to be confirmed by the office'.

Q: What does 'Proposed' mean?

A: The Handbook and the Protocol are both silent, so the group proposes the rule (for example, the Dean may extend a research time limit once). These are the answers most worth checking.

Q: Why the 2022-2023 Handbook?

A: It is the latest edition we were given. If a later edition or memo exists, please send it; a later memo replaces the rule it covers (OQ-38).

Q: What about the forms pack?

A: Not for today. It is ready (60 documents, 108 pages, Documents/Graduate_School/Forms/USLS-GS-Forms-Pack.pdf) and listed in Appendix A of the manual; we can go through it at another meeting.

Answers they may ask about (from pages 2-3)

Topic (OQ)	Our answer	Basis
Subject withdrawal (OQ-01)	Until the end of week 2; 10% fee in week 1, 20% in week 2.	Handbook pp. 49, 51
Dropping (OQ-04, 05)	Recorded by the Academic Coordinator only, above 20% unexcused absences; no approval step.	Handbook p. 52 + platform
Leave of absence (OQ-09, 10, 11)	One year, renewable once; counts toward maximum residence; may start until two weeks before the last day of classes.	Handbook pp. 52-55
Letter or form (OQ-12)	The platform form counts as the written request; a pending request may be withdrawn.	Platform
Readmission (OQ-13)	Both the Handbook's and the platform's lists; the Academic Coordinator interviews; the Dean's Advise Slip clears enrollment.	Handbook p. 45 + platform
AWOL (OQ-14)	After one semester with no enrollment and no approved leave; counts toward maximum residence.	Platform
Comprehensive exam (OQ-17)	Passed before the title defense and the adviser; the office can switch the check off.	Handbook p. 57
Adviser (OQ-19, 21)	Dean, Associate Dean and Research Coordinator together; Form 3 names one adviser who agreed.	Protocol
Publication (OQ-25)	Required for students enrolled from AY 2022-2023; earlier students present at a conference.	Handbook p. 77
E-approval (OQ-47)	Platform approval accepted as the signature, except where the Protocol requires an e-signature on the form.	Proposed
Privacy (OQ-48)	The University's Data Protection Officer; consent at first sign-in; outside AI service off.	Proposed

3. UAT and the Feature Checklist

Feature Checklist (FEATURE-CHECKLIST.pdf, 3 pages)

- **What it is:** 43 features in 10 groups (sign-in, records, offering and enrollment, withdrawal and dropping, leave/readmission/AWOL/residency, research, practicum, graduation, reports, Policy Assistant and rules). Each row: where to see it, Yes/No, remarks. Signature at the end.

- **Where it comes from:** the team walkthrough (Cases 2 to 27). It checks that each feature is there and works; the UAT form checks it in depth.

UAT form (12 pages)

- **What it measures:** whether the demonstrated system supports the real monitoring and coordination needs of the Graduate School. Each evaluator judges only what was seen or done. All records are sample data.
- **Who answers what:** everyone answers Sections A, I, J and K and the User Acceptance page (last page). Each other section has a 'Mainly for' line. The SUS page is optional. Taking part is voluntary; any question may be skipped.
- **How it runs:** testers watch the team's videos, then use miguisanson.dev on their own time within the window, then fill in the form. Time per tester is not measured yet: plan about 30-45 minutes.
- **Acceptance:** each evaluator ticks one of Accepted, Accepted with minor revisions, Requires major revisions, and gives a reason.

Role	Sections for this role	Plus, for everyone
Dean	C, G, H	A, I, J, K, acceptance page
Academic Coordinator	B, C, D, G, H (reports)	A, I, J, K, acceptance page
Research Coordinator	D, E, F, G, H (reports)	A, I, J, K, acceptance page
Faculty (adviser or panel)	D, E, F	A, I, J, K, acceptance page
Student	C, D, F, G	A, I, J, K, acceptance page
GS Staff	B to H (heaviest; split between two staff if possible)	A, I, J, K, acceptance page

Section	Topic	Qs
A	Overall system and process representation	7
B	Student records, course monitoring, enrollment	14
C	Standing changes and exception cases (withdrawal, dropping, leave, readmission, AWOL, residency)	9
D	Research Gate	10
E	Panel matching	8
F	Defense scheduling and defense outcome	14
G	Practicum and graduation	8
H	Policy Assistant, rules, reports and analytics	13
I	User interface and ease of use	8
J	Access, reliability, system behavior	7
SUS	System Usability Scale (optional)	10
K	Process validation and possible errors (Yes = a problem was found)	8

- **Scales:** Yes / No / N/A on every row; in A-J, Yes always means good. Rating rows use 1-5 with the words printed on the row, plus N/A. Section K is reversed: Yes means a problem was found (labelled on the page). SUS is 1-5, Strongly disagree to Strongly agree.
- **Scoring Yes/No:** every answer traces to one question ID (A1, B3 ...); the team tallies No answers per question and reads the comments. No pass percentage is set: check with the adviser before quoting one.
- **Scoring SUS (team use):** odd items = answer minus 1; even items = 5 minus answer; add the ten and multiply by 2.5 (0-100). About 68 is the usual average. With few evaluators, report each score and the range.

Q: Why ISO/IEC 25010 and ISO 9241-11?

A: 25010 is a software quality model; a UAT with office staff can judge only some of its characteristics (functional suitability, usability, security, reliability). 9241-11 defines usability as effectiveness, efficiency and satisfaction for specified users in a specified context, which is why the form records the role and the sample-data context. No CHED or USLS rule requires 25010 that we found.

Q: Why add SUS?

A: Ten items on one page, validated, one comparable number. Optional, because SUS is meant for people who used the system, not only watched.

Q: Why mostly Yes/No?

A: It is a short acceptance check; the draft used Yes/No and the team kept it. The rating rows give a degree of usefulness or ease.

Q: What changed from the draft?

A: Evaluator block (who tested what), N/A on every row, words on every rating point, double questions split, out-of-date questions replaced, new questions for features the draft never covered, duplicate removed, larger print, optional SUS page. Each change and its source is in Documents/Capstone/UAT/UAT-REVIEW-NOTES.md.

Q: Are the policy numbers in the questions right?

A: Withdrawal window and 10% / 20% fee: Handbook pp. 49, 51. 20% absence: p. 52. Scores 85 / 90: p. 67. The 14-day lead time comes from the rules register.

Q: Who sees the answers?

A: Names and signatures are used only for the CAP-2521-IT capstone and shared only with the project team and the Graduate School (Data Privacy Act, RA 10173).

Q: Does a good result prove the system works?

A: No. It records acceptance of a demonstration build with sample data. Evaluators judge only what was shown.

4. The demo videos (my parts)

The team's videos cover every part; groupmates answer questions on their own parts. Below: my parts only.

Part	Video (about)	What it shows
2d	2d-Monitoring-Sheet.mp4 (4:30)	The Monitoring Sheet: the Excel curriculum grid, kept on screen
2h	2h-1-Leave-of-Absence.mp4 (6:37) 2h-2-Readmission.mp4 (4:28) 2h-3-AWOL-and-Return-from-AWOL.mp4 (5:08)	Leave of absence, readmission, AWOL and return from AWOL, on one kind of board
2l	2l-Reports-Analytics.mp4 (4:19)	What the Graduate School knows about all students at once
2m	no video (spoken closing)	Best features; text at the end of videos/NARRATION-SCRIPT.docx

Demo accounts: all use the same demo password; the sign-in page lists them. Staff: staff@usls.edu.ph. Dean: dean@usls.edu.ph. Students: loa.daniel@usls.edu.ph (leave), readmission.therese@usls.edu.ph (readmission), awol.maya@usls.edu.ph (AWOL).

2d - Monitoring Sheet

- **One line:** the curriculum grid the office kept in Excel (one row per student, one column per subject) is now kept on screen, and every entry shows where it came from.
- **Where:** Records > Monitoring Sheet. GS Staff and the Academic Coordinator can edit; the Research Coordinator and the Dean view only.
- **Provenance:** every value is 'Imported' (from the Academic Coordinator's workbook) or 'Manual entry' (who, when, reason). Changing an imported value needs a written reason. A later workbook that disagrees is held for review, not overwritten.
- **Removing a row does not erase it:** it goes back to 'not taken' and stays in the history. Adding a student creates a Student Portal login. Grades are never entered here: AIMS is the official source.

Q: Why not keep the Excel file?

A: Excel cannot show who changed a cell, when or why, and every coordinator keeps a different copy. Here there is one record, every change is audited, and the same data feeds Enrollment, Reports and the student's own view. Workbook upload still works.

Q: Can someone change official data by mistake?

A: Not silently. An imported value needs a written reason, the change is logged with the person's name, and grades and official enrollment cannot be edited at all.

Q: Where does the imported data come from?

A: The Academic Coordinator's monitoring workbook, uploaded under Student Handoff. The import checks required fields and duplicates.

2h - Leave of Absence, Readmission, AWOL

One line: three standing changes on one kind of board. Columns are stages, cards are requests, the request window shows the policy check, and the Registrar list is the hand-off.

Case	What happens	Rule behind it
Leave of Absence (Daniel Fernandez)	Student files the leave (semesters, reason, explanation). Staff review it on the board, read the policy check, forward to the Dean; the card then locks for staff. The Dean approves (or returns or denies, with a comment). Staff start the leave and send the Registrar list (download, mark as sent).	Handbook p. 52: written request to the Dean with reason and period; one year, renewable once. p. 53: not within two weeks before the last day of classes. Leave counts toward maximum residence.
Readmission (Therese Lacson)	Student files a return request (leave pre-filled, return semester, why ready, checklist). Staff verify the checklist and forward; unticked items reach the Dean as Needs review. The Dean approves: the student is active again. Readmission does not enroll; the Academic Coordinator plans subjects next.	p. 53: intention to enroll in writing to the Registrar through the Dean. p. 45: clearance, interview, evaluation, Advise Slip. Our answer OQ-13: both lists apply.

Case	What happens	Rule behind it
AWOL and Return (Maya Torres)	Nobody types 'AWOL': the system flags it from the records. Staff cannot move the card. The student files a Return from AWOL declaration; staff check the residence limits and forward; the Dean decides.	p. 53: leaving without a formal leave is AWOL. pp. 54-55: master's 5 years normal, 7 absolute; doctorate 7 and 9; extension of up to 2 years with a 6-unit refresher.

Q: Why does the portal not e-mail the Registrar?

A: On purpose. The portal prepares the list; Graduate School staff send it through the official channel, then mark it sent. There is always a record of what was handed over.

Q: Can staff approve a leave?

A: No. Staff review and forward; the card locks for staff once the Dean has it. The server refuses any move the rules do not allow, even by drag and drop.

Q: What does 'Needs review' mean?

A: A rule value the Graduate School still has to confirm (a prototype value). The portal shows it honestly, and the Dean decides.

Q: Is the paper leave letter still needed?

A: The Handbook asks for a written request to the Dean (p. 52). Our answer (OQ-12): the portal form counts as the written request. The Dean can correct that. The forms pack also has the paper version.

Q: What if a student is flagged AWOL by mistake?

A: The flag comes from the imported standing or the semester records, so the fix is to correct the source record, or the student files a return. Nobody can type the flag by hand, so nobody is flagged by accident.

2l - Reports & Analytics

- **One line:** what the Graduate School knows about all students at once. Every number is computed from recorded events, not typed in, and every count opens the students behind it.
- **Where:** Overview > Reports & Analytics. Filters: program, entry cohort, period (default last 12 months). Six numbers on top (for example Behind schedule, Median days to decide).
- **Tabs:** Needs attention, Where students get stuck (on time, slow, stuck), Office speed, Records to fix, Cohorts by stage, Graduation candidates, Overdue and pending, Defenses, Registrar changes. Excel or PDF download.
- Risk reads 'Not Yet Assessed' until the Graduate School confirms its risk rules. The portal never invents High, Medium or Low.

Q: Where do the targets (10%, 7 days) come from?

A: Starting values for discussion, not Graduate School policy. The Graduate School should set its own; changing a target is a setting.

Q: Is the data real?

A: No. The demo site holds sample data (made-up students). No real student data is stored.

Q: Can this feed CHED or university reports?

A: Every table downloads as Excel or PDF with the current filters. If a fixed report format exists, give us the template and we match it.

2m - Best features (if asked what is strongest)

- **Rules with a source:** one register, each rule with its Handbook or Protocol page and a label (Enforced by the system, Documented only, Needs review). A refusal quotes the rule.
- **Policy Assistant that cites its source:** answers only from the Graduate School's documents, names the document and page, says so when the documents do not cover a question.
- **Panel matching that explains itself:** score out of 100 = topic similarity 60 + availability 25 + workload 15, shown on screen. The student's own adviser is never offered. A person chooses the panel.
- **Scheduling that checks before it books:** hard stops (double-booked panelist or room, declined invitation, slot in the past) and warnings that can be overridden with a recorded reason. Calendars for every role.
- **Shared boards and reports from records:** leave, readmission, AWOL, withdrawal, practicum and graduation run on the same boards; every move is recorded.
- **Common thread:** each feature takes data the Graduate School already has, plus the policy that governs it, and produces a decision, a warning or a measurement.

Q: Is the 60 / 25 / 15 weighting policy?

A: No. It is a design choice. The UAT form asks evaluators (E3) whether it is sensible; the Graduate School should confirm it.

5. General questions

Q: Who can see what?

A: Each account has one role: Student, Faculty, GS Staff, Academic Coordinator, Research Coordinator, Dean, Administrator. The server decides which portal opens and checks the role on every action, not only in the menu.

Q: Is it secure enough for real data?

A: It was built and tested as a demo: password sign-in with lockout, role checks on every request, audit log, security headers, size-limited uploads. Before real data it needs the university's sign-in, hosting by the university's IT, backups and a data-privacy review under the Data Privacy Act of 2012.

Q: Does it replace AIMS?

A: No. AIMS stays the official system for identity, enrollment and grades. The portal reads AIMS exports and prepares lists for the Registrar to apply in AIMS.

Q: What technology is it?

A: Python (Flask) back end, SQLite database, React front end. It runs on one computer; for the demo it is published through a Cloudflare Tunnel at miguisanson.dev.

Q: How was it tested?

A: Automated tests run on every change, and the screens of every role were clicked through in a browser before the demo.

Q: Where did the processes come from?

A: The Graduate School Handbook 2022-2023, the Research Protocol AY 2024-2025, the Academic Coordinator's monitoring sheets, the defense panel's comments, and our draft Operations Manual. Each rule on screen names its source.

Q: Does it work on a phone?

A: Yes. Every board becomes a card list on a phone, and the Dean's screens were tested at phone size.

Q: What if the Policy Assistant gives a wrong answer?

A: It is decision support, not an official ruling. It answers only from the policy documents and shows the passage it used; when the documents do not cover a question it says so. Today it runs offline (Gemini was failing on 4 Nov), so answers say 'Offline answer' and still cite the Handbook page.

Q: Google Calendar?

A: Optional, per faculty member, from My Calendar. It reads only free/busy times and writes only the defense events the system creates. Testers must be added as Google test users while the Google app is in testing.

Q: Anyone can sign in with the demo accounts?

A: Yes, on purpose for the UAT: the sign-in page lists them. Only sample data is on the site, and a reset rebuilds it.

Q: Can you add a feature we need?

A: Write it down, say it goes into the improvement list, and ask which office would use it and how often.

6. If something goes wrong

Problem	Do this
Site does not load	Check the PC is on and the window 'USLS site - keep open' is open. If not, double-click deploy\START-SITE.cmd and leave both windows open; after a minute https://miguisanson.dev/api/health should say status ok. Backup on this PC: http://127.0.0.1:5000.
A demo student is already used up	Sign-in page > Demo accounts > Reset next to that student.
Drag and drop does not move a card	Use 'Move to...' on the card, or the button in View details. Same step, same rules.
Numbers differ from the video	Expected: reports are live measurements. Read them off the screen.
Policy Assistant says 'Offline answer'	Expected today (Gemini off). To turn Gemini back on: delete the line set GOOGLE_API_KEY=off in deploy\START-SITE.cmd and restart the site.
Withdrawal window is closed	The demo semester is dated from the day of the seed: reset the demo data (deploy\RESET-DEMO-DATA.cmd, then deploy\START-SITE.cmd).

7. Where every file is

What	Where (under E:\Github_Projects\CAPSTONE-USLS-MVP\Documents\)
What I send (4 PDFs)	Capstone\Meeting_2026-11-04\For Stakeholder\ - USLS GS Operations Manual - DRAFT for Validation.pdf, FEATURE-CHECKLIST.pdf, OPERATIONS-MANUAL-SUMMARY-AND-SIGN-OFF.pdf, [CAP-IT2] UAT Instrument - Revised.pdf. Word copies in 'Word files'.
Demo videos, narration script	Capstone\Meeting_2026-11-04\videos\ (this PC only)

What	Where (under E:\Github_Projects\CAPSTONE-USLS-MVP\Documents\)
Operations Manual (unchanged)	Graduate_School\Operations_Manual\USLS GS Operations Manual - DRAFT for Validation.pdf (and .docx). The web app reads it: do not rename.
UAT original and change notes	Capstone\UAT\ - the revised form and UAT-REVIEW-NOTES.md
Forms pack (for later)	Graduate_School\Forms\USLS-GS-Forms-Pack.pdf (108 pages, 60 documents)
Team walkthrough	Capstone\Walkthrough\CAP-2521-IT-WALKTHROUGH.docx (Cases 2-27)
Older prep	Capstone\Meeting_2026-11-04\Archive\ - Decision Sheet (for another time), the two old cheat sheets, the old README (Cloudflare and Google Calendar setup)